

Intersect

2025 Annual Report



INTERSECT™

Message from the Board of Directors

On behalf of the Board, we are pleased to introduce Intersect's 2025 Annual Report.

2025 was the year Cardano governance moved from aspiration to operation. The community now holds the levers of decision-making, and the Board's role through this period has been to provide oversight, continuity, and confidence that the organization entrusted with coordinating much of this work remains accountable to its members.

It was also a year of significant change for Intersect itself. The transition to a majority-elected Governing Board, new leadership, and a sharpened scope marked important steps in aligning the organization more closely with the community it serves. We want to recognize the care with which these were navigated.

The Board's responsibility is to hold the organization to account on behalf of members: to test that resources are directed where they matter most, that financial management is prudent, and that Intersect's expanding remit does not come at the cost of clarity or trust. We are satisfied that 2025 was concluded within the approved budget, leaving Intersect on a stronger and more sustainable footing.

We remain mindful that Intersect supports and facilitates rather than directs. Its value lies in enabling members and the wider community to coordinate, respond, and deliver, and the Board sees its task as protecting that principle as the organization's responsibilities grow in 2026.

We thank the Executive Director and the entire team for their work through a demanding year, and our members and community for their continued participation and scrutiny. There is more to do, and we enter 2026 confident in the direction set.

The Board of Directors Intersect

Mercy Fordwoo, Nikhil Joshi, Kavinda Kariyapperuma, Prof Steven Lupien, Rand McHenry, Gerard Moroney, and Adam Rush

Message from the Executive Director

2025 was a defining year for Intersect, and for Cardano. For the first time, decision-making across Cardano was carried forward by the community itself. That shift brought both opportunity and challenge, reinforcing my belief that the core cypherpunk ethos underpinning blockchain must remain central, while recognizing Cardano's governance model as a meaningful step forward in how decentralized systems coordinate and deliver.

For Intersect, it was also a year of reflection and change. Under new leadership, we stepped back to reassess our role, structure, and ways of working. We sharpened our focus across our core responsibilities and embedded a meaningful shift in our culture, allowing us to operate with greater discipline and better serve our members and the wider ecosystem.

I am incredibly proud of the Intersect team for how they have navigated this period. Alongside supporting Cardano's critical technical coordination and security response capabilities, Intersect now administers over A\$350m worth of Treasury-funded initiatives on behalf of the ecosystem. In a relatively short period of time, the organization has taken on increasingly critical responsibilities and evolved significantly in both capability and scope. I am equally grateful to our members and the wider Cardano community, whose contributions, insights, and participation have added immense value to our work and to Cardano overall.

From a financial perspective, we closed the year operating fully within our approved budget. Despite transition, market volatility, and expanding responsibilities, we maintained discipline and aligned resources to our core objectives. This has put Intersect on a stronger footing as we move into 2026, with a continued responsibility to ensure the value we deliver remains aligned with the needs of the ecosystem.

As we move into 2026, governance is no longer new. It is the baseline. The focus now shifts to refining what we have built, improving coordination, and ensuring the ecosystem can move with clarity and purpose. We have made strong progress, but there is always more to do. Thank you to everyone who has contributed to this journey.



Jack Briggs
Executive Director

Who we are

What is Intersect?

Intersect is a member-based organization within the Cardano ecosystem that supports coordination, continuity, and delivery across the network. It brings members together to address Cardano's most important challenges and opportunities, while enabling effective collaboration across governance, technical coordination, incident response, and the administration of community-approved initiatives from Cardano's Treasury.

Through this role, Intersect helps ensure the ecosystem remains resilient, transparent, and capable of evolving in line with member and community priorities.

Our Purpose

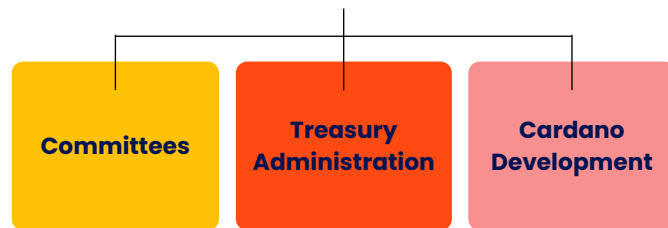
Ultimately, Intersect exists to help our members coordinate, respond, and solve Cardano's biggest challenges and opportunities.

Intersect's member-led governing board and steering committee provide high-level oversight



Which is occupied and administered by Intersect Members

We support and evolve:



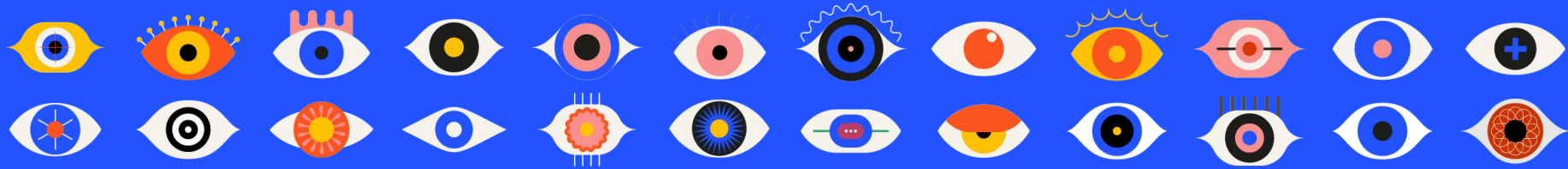
A note on 2025

In retrospect, the 2025 Cardano Treasury budget process was marked by transition and reflection. During this period, we navigated considerable uncertainty, as is ever present in our industry. We also learned a great deal about how to be a more effective member-based organization serving the Cardano ecosystem as it entered full on-chain governance.

Cardano made significant progress last year and, as a result, adapting to these changes required leadership to ensure Intersect as an organization remained effective and in lockstep with the broader needs of the ecosystem. This period marked leadership changes, including our Governing Board becoming a majority-elected body and the appointment of an Interim Executive Director.

We also established new processes and reassessed the scope of Intersect amid uncertainty and organizational evolution. These efforts resulted in a budget aligned with strategic priorities and a clearer understanding of resource allocation. This year laid the groundwork for disciplined, impact-driven financial management ahead.

While our budget remains aligned with the original funding categories, the figures have been rebalanced to better support the evolved scope and objectives of Intersect.



Our expense allocation

1

2

3

4

Core Operations & Administration

The Operations sector forms the backbone of Intersect's accountability and resilience. By integrating our core administrative functions with a strategic approach to our workforce, we ensure that every initiative is supported by a robust legal and financial framework.

Product & Membership

The Product & Membership sector provides the digital and structural framework that puts members in the driving seat of Cardano's future. This involves bridging technical engineering with the member-led governance processes that solve the ecosystem's biggest challenges.

Ecosystem & Community

The Ecosystem & Community sector serves as the main link between Intersect's operations and the global Cardano community. Its core task is to manage the full on-chain governance, ensuring the network's decentralization remains transparent, inclusive, and informed by member participation.

Cardano Technology

The Cardano Technology sector is dedicated to the technical stewardship, continuity, and coordination of the network. This sector ensures that Intersect remains effective and aligned with the needs of the ecosystem by managing core infrastructure and technical governance.

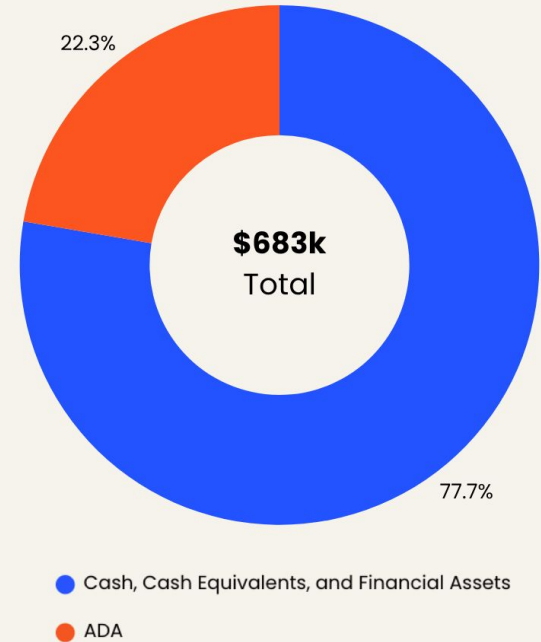
Our assets held

Transparency and accountability are at the heart of Intersect's mission. As a member-led organization, we are committed to ensuring that our financial management reflects the highest standards of integrity.

As of December 31, 2025, our total financial position of \$683k is comprised primarily of cash, cash equivalents, and other financial assets totaling \$503k. This category includes held in operational bank accounts for immediate liquidity, alongside in other financial assets such as deposits and accounts receivable. The remaining, is held in digital assets (ADA), a \$152k valued balance that encompasses our dedicated committee rewards wallet used to incentivize and empower member-led oversight.

Our 2025 financial statements have been independently audited by our accountants, SOVO, and filed with the State of Wyoming in accordance with our obligations as a Wyoming nonprofit corporation. Beyond these statutory requirements, we are publishing our full accounts on-chain using Reeve, Cardano's own financial reporting platform. This makes our financial position not simply reported, but independently verifiable by any member of the community, at any time, without intermediaries.

Our assets held in Intersect seeks to balance revenue and expenditure. Our 2025 Treasury award is drawn down from the Cardano Development Holdings in line with milestones throughout 2025 and 2026.



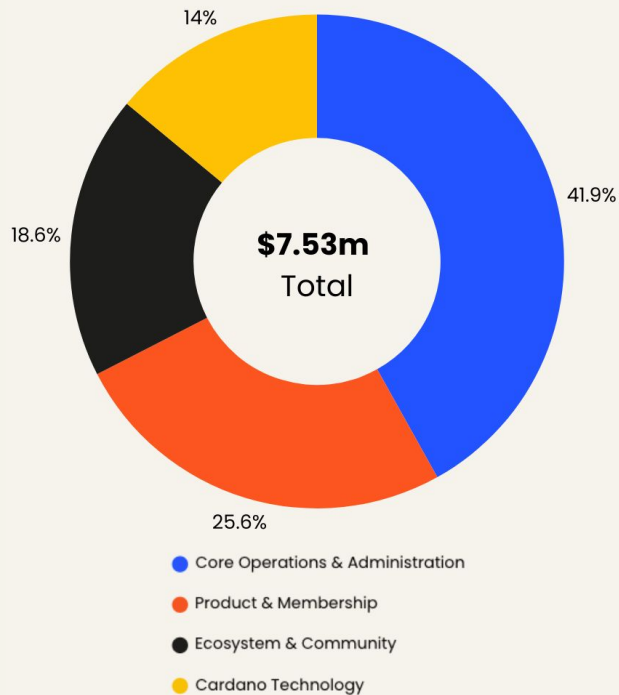
Our annual expenses

Our 2025 financial results reflect the full deployment of resources in service of our core mission. Our spend was aligned to strategic priorities, resulting in a balanced net position within the scope approved by the community.

During the year, we responded to expanding responsibilities by building an Administration function capable of safeguarding community-approved Treasury spend, including the smart contract framework now in operation. We also expanded our coordination responsibilities through the formation of the Pentad and matured our technical coordination and incident response capabilities. Market conditions also had an impact throughout the year, which we modeled for and remained agile in responding to.

These developments required targeted investment and internal restructuring. Despite this expanded scope, we maintained operational efficiency and disciplined financial management, **concluding the year under our budget ask** (\$7,875m) while strengthening governance, delivery oversight, and ecosystem resilience.

Every figure in this report is drawn from accounts that have been independently audited, filed with the State of Wyoming, and published on-chain. As a recipient and administrator of Treasury funds, we hold ourselves to a standard of transparency that the community can verify rather than take on trust.



**Now, let's look at
our 2025
highlights**

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2025 Highlights

CARDANO's GROWTH



Coordination of
Plomin Upgrade
which brought
**Cardano to full
decentralized
governance**
*(The first
community-driven
hard fork in blockchain
history)*



Established
**mainnet incident
response
capability**
*(most notably the chain
partition incident in
November 2025)*



**Stewardship and
maintenance**
coordination across
100+ repositories,
including core
Cardano
infrastructure



Development and
coordination of
Cardano 2030
**Vision, Mission and
strategy** framework

More details on our detailed [2025 annual report](#)

2025 Highlights

CARDANO'S GROWTH

COORDINATION OF PLOMIN UPGRADE

The first community-driven
hardfork in blockchain history

Fully
decentralized
governance

The Chang upgrade, completed with the Plomin hard fork, marked a key milestone for Cardano. The network is now governed by its community, allowing ada holders to vote directly or delegate their power.

Cardano has now entered the Voltaire era. Governance actions such as protocol updates and treasury decisions can be proposed, voted on, and executed fully on-chain.

The Plomin hard fork completed the governance framework and enabled full DRep participation. It sets a new standard for decentralized on-chain governance at scale.

[More details about Plomin Upgrade](#)

2025 Highlights

STEWARDSHIP & MAINTENANCE

Coordination across core Cardano infrastructure



CARDANO'S GROWTH

Intersect supports the stewardship of Cardano's core repositories by providing coordination, oversight, and operational structure across contributors. This ensures that development remains aligned, transparent, and accessible, enabling a broad set of teams to collaborate effectively on critical infrastructure.

Ongoing maintenance of core repositories is essential to the reliability and evolution of the network. Through structured processes, release coordination, and contributor support, Intersect helps ensure that updates are managed consistently, risks are reduced, and the ecosystem can continue to build on a stable foundation.

2025 Highlights

CARDANO's CRITICAL PROCESSES



Contributions to drafting and **approval of Cardano's first Constitution**



Coordination of the **first Constitutional Committee elections**



Contribution to and submission of **45+ governance actions**

(65% of all governance actions)



Facilitation of the **first ecosystem budget process**

Operational **support** for **budget and treasury administration** processes



More details on our detailed [2025 annual report](#)

2025 Highlights

CARDANO's CRITICAL PROCESSES



Contributions to
drafting and **approval**
of **Cardano's first**
Constitution

Cardano's first Constitution was shaped through a global community process, with workshops and a Constitutional Convention bringing together delegates from across the ecosystem. The final version was approved by delegates and submitted on-chain for DReps and the Constitutional Committee to ratify, establishing the rules and principles that guide Cardano's governance.



Coordination of the **first**
Constitutional Committee
elections

In 2025, Cardano held its first fully community-driven Constitutional Committee elections. DReps voted to select members responsible for ensuring governance actions align with the Constitution, completing the transition from interim structures to a fully decentralized governance model.

More details about [Cardano's constitution](#) and [CC elections](#)

2025 Highlights

CARDANO's CRITICAL PROCESSES



Contribution to and submission of

45+ governance actions

(65% of all governance actions)

In 2025, more than 45 governance actions were submitted on-chain, covering key areas such as treasury continuity, budget proposals, constitutional updates, and long-term strategy. These actions reflect a system in active use, where decisions are continuously proposed, reviewed, and voted on by the community.



Facilitation of the

first ecosystem budget process

Operational **support**
for **budget and treasury**
administration processes

In 2025, Intersect facilitated Cardano's first ecosystem-wide budget process, providing the structure, tools, and operational support for proposals, discussions, and prioritization. This enabled the community and DReps to engage effectively, establishing a transparent and coordinated approach to treasury allocation.

More details about first [Cardano Budget process](#) & our [administration services](#)

2025 Highlights

INTERSECT COORDINATION AND SUPPORT SERVICES



Supported over
6,000 participants
across members
in **74 countries**



Transitioned to a
majority elected Board
representing the
membership



Coordinated
8 elected committees
covering key areas
of ecosystem development



Facilitates
30+ working groups
involving subject
matter experts across
the community



Administrator for over
**100 community
proposals**
representing more than
A\$350 million
in approved initiatives



Participating in
**Pentad coordination
group**
facilitating critical
infrastructure
integrations into
Cardano ecosystem

More details on our detailed [2025 annual report](#)

2025 Highlights

INTERSECT COORDINATION AND SUPPORT SERVICES



Transitioned to a **majority elected Board**, representing the membership

In October 2025, Intersect facilitated board elections that transitioned the organization to a majority elected board. For the first time, members directly selected representatives, strengthening accountability and aligning governance more closely with the community.



Coordinated **8 elected committees** covering key areas of ecosystem development

In April and October 2025, Intersect facilitated committee elections, providing the structure, processes, and operational support for members to select representatives across key governance bodies. These elected committees play a critical role in shaping priorities, reviewing initiatives, and guiding ecosystem decisions, strengthening accountability and ensuring governance reflects the needs of the community.

More details about Intersect Board and Committee elections (april - october)

A note on the Cardano Development Holdings

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An entity we administer

Cardano Development Holdings (CDH) is a non-profit entity established with a single, clear mission: to advance and strengthen the Cardano ecosystem. Think of CDH as a dedicated engine for the network's most critical needs. It holds the ownership of key financial assets and relies on Intersect to act as its hands-on administrator, managing the day-to-day engagements and resources that keep the development of the blockchain moving forward.



A leaner, more focused strategy

As Cardano has moved toward a more decentralized, community-controlled treasury, the strategy for CDH has evolved into something leaner and more targeted. While it used to handle a broader range of funding, it is now focused exclusively on the "completely necessary" pillars of Cardano's technical development.

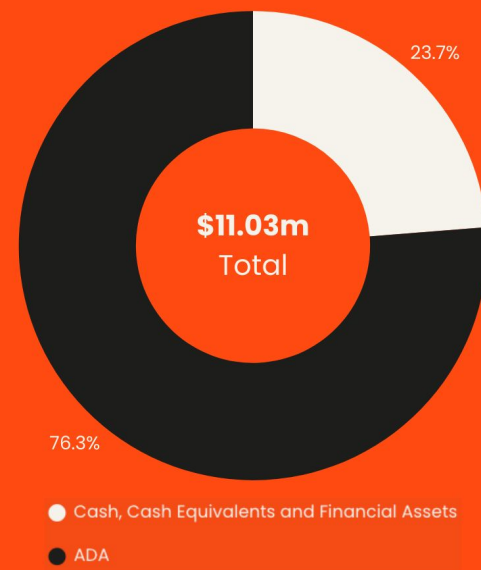
By concentrating these resources on the most essential infrastructure, we ensure that the network's foundation remains rock-solid and resilient. This focused approach means that every dollar or digital asset held by CDH is being preserved for the vital maintenance and core upgrades that guarantee Cardano stays up and running for the long term.



CDH assets held

As we move into a more mature phase of the ecosystem's lifecycle, the financial position of Cardano Development Holdings (CDH) has been strategically refined to focus on core technical resilience. As of December 31, 2025, CDH maintains a total asset base of \$11.03m. These resources are managed to provide a stable backstop for Cardano's most vital infrastructure, ensuring that essential development continues regardless of market conditions.

The CDH is an ADA-first entity, with its allocation reflecting a deep, fundamental alignment with the network. 76% of the portfolio is held in digital assets, comprising \$8.41m in ADA. This ensures that the entity's value and success are intrinsically tied to the long-term health of the Cardano blockchain. The remaining 24% of the portfolio consists of \$2.62m in cash and cash equivalents. These liquid reserves are held specifically to meet critical operational commitments and fund the necessary technical maintenance required to guarantee the network's uninterrupted progress.

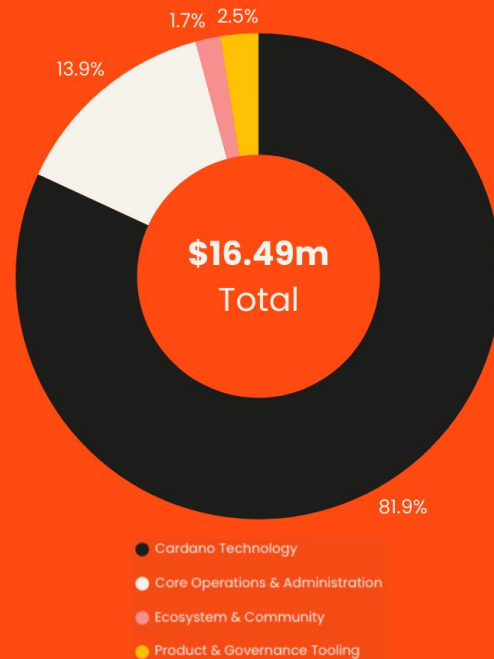


CDH annual expenses

Our 2025 expenditures represent a purposeful deployment of \$16.49m into community-governed digital utility. By prioritizing technical stewardship and operational stability, we have ensured the ecosystem is not only running but ready to scale.

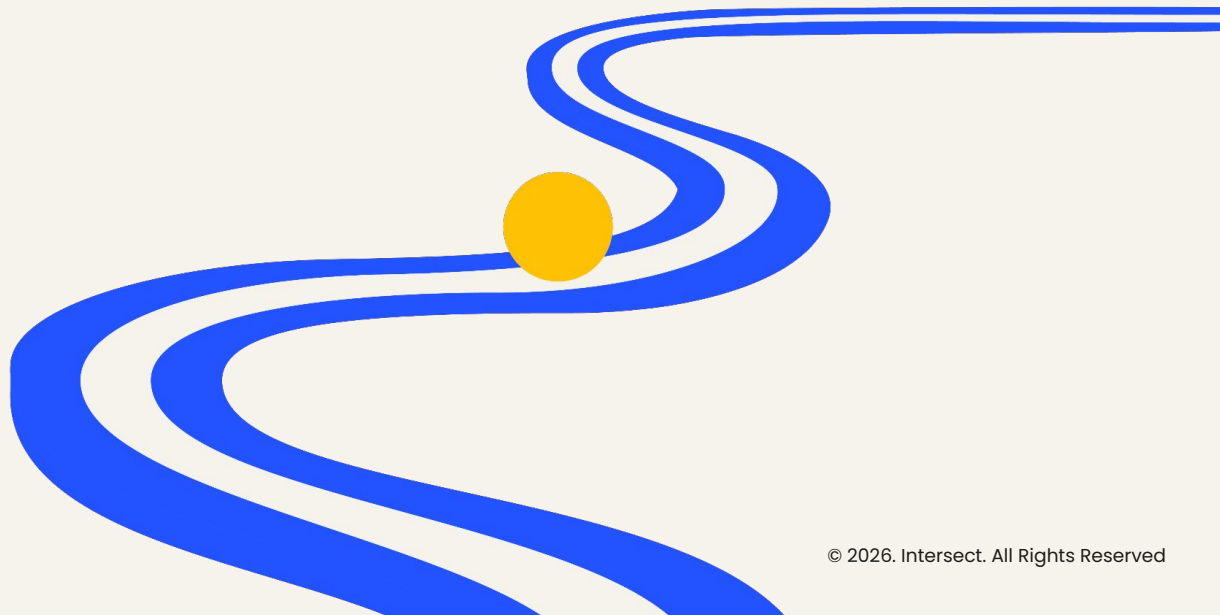
Where the funds went

- **Cardano Technology (\$13.5m):** Our primary contractual allocation, largely dedicated to essential legacy technical work in the rollout of the Chang and Plomin upgrades, fulfilling core contracts established in 2024. This also includes critical smart contract development in collaboration with SundaeLabs to expand the network's Treasury management capabilities.
- **Core Operations & Administration (\$2.3m):** The administrative backbone required to manage 45 funded projects and over 430 milestones, providing the legal, financial, and ICT infrastructure that keeps the organization resilient. This is also inclusive of Intersect's treasury proposal in 2025.
- **Product & Governance Tooling (\$0.4m):** This investment was primarily focused on GovTool, the earliest interface for on-chain governance. This includes the engineering and maintenance required to allow DReps and ada holders to vote, delegate, and interact with the governance framework seamlessly.
- **Ecosystem & Community (\$0.3m):** Dedicated to the drafting and ratification of Cardano's first Constitution. It also includes the cost of a legacy commitment for institutional-grade transparency through professional ecosystem reporting from partners like Messari.



Looking ahead

2026

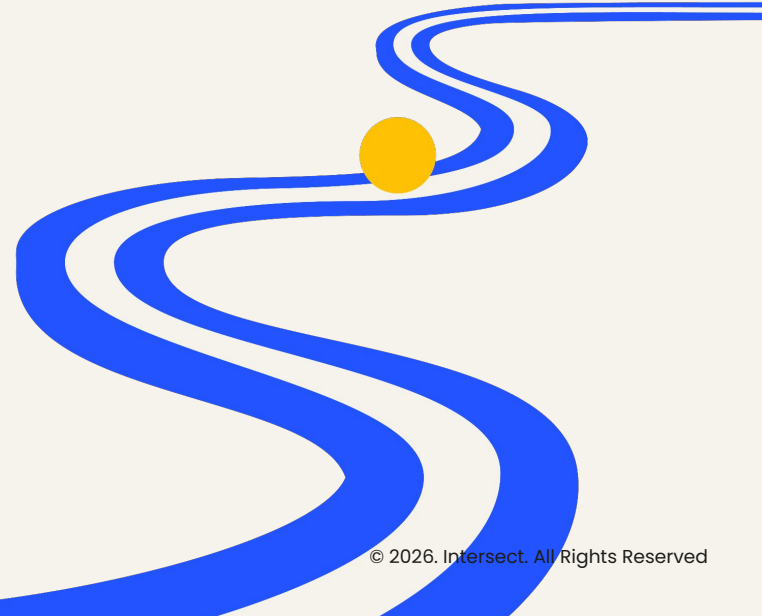


Looking ahead

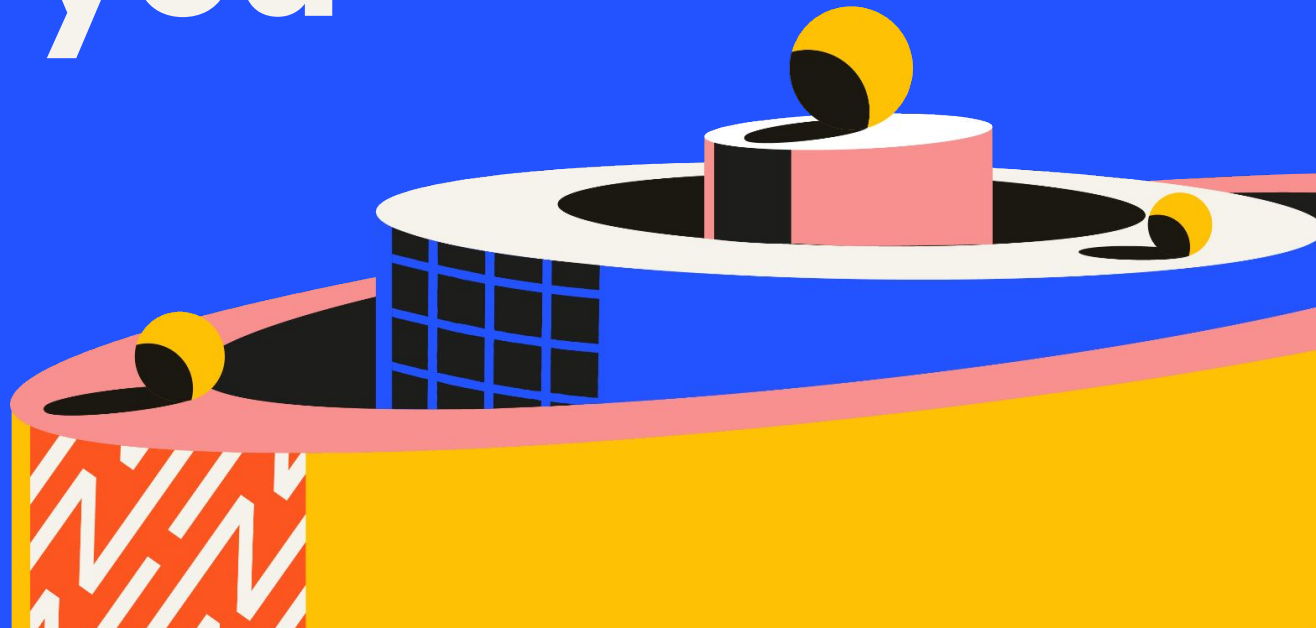
Reflecting on the historic milestones of 2025 – from the first ratified constitution to the activation of a community-led treasury – Intersect enters 2026 with a matured perspective and a clear mandate. We recognize that as governance becomes the "new normal," our role must evolve from initiating these systems to refining and scaling them. Your feedback throughout this transition has been vital, helping us sharpen our focus on transparency and operational excellence.

As we move through 2026, we are committed to further stabilizing our operations and directing resources toward the areas of highest impact. Our resources will prioritize deepening remit and our role with stewarding the core Cardano node including incident response and a renewed effort to improve member engagement, and effectiveness. By maintaining strict discipline over discretionary costs and aligning our spend to the needs of the ecosystem, we are building a sustainable foundation for continued delivery.

With clear momentum across our sectors, Intersect remains a dedicated partner in facilitating the community's vision for a decentralized, thriving Cardano.



Thank you



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